

1.9 STATUS IN WALES AND NORTHERN IRELAND

This specification has been approved by ACCAC for use by Centres in Wales and by CCEA for use by Centres in Northern Ireland.

Candidates in Wales and Northern Ireland should not be disadvantaged by terms, legislation or aspects of government that are different from those in England. Where such situations might occur, including in the external assessment, the terms used have been selected as neutral, so that candidates may apply whatever is appropriate to their own situation.

OCR will provide specifications, assessments and supporting documentation only in English.

Further information on the provision of assessment materials in Welsh and Irish may be obtained from the Information Bureau at OCR (telephone 01223 553998).

2 Specification Aims

This GCSE Music Specification conforms to the regulations laid down within the Music subject criteria (QCA 1999), and as such aims:

- to give candidates opportunities to develop their understanding and appreciation of a range of different kinds of music, extend their own interests and increase their ability to make judgements about musical quality;
- to give candidates opportunities to acquire the knowledge, skills and understanding needed to:
 - make music both individually and in groups;
 - develop a lifelong interest in music, e.g. through community music making;
 - progress to further study, e.g. A/AS level and other equivalent qualifications and/or to follow a music-related career, where appropriate;
- to give candidates opportunities to develop broader life skills and attributes including critical and creative thinking, aesthetic sensitivity and emotional and cultural development.

3 Assessment Objectives

The specification requires candidates to demonstrate aural perception, musical knowledge and understanding and communication through three inter-related assessment objectives:

Assessment Objective 1 (AO1)

Sing and/or play an individual part with technical control, expression, interpretation and, where appropriate, a sense of ensemble. (Performing)

Assessment Objective 2 (AO2)

Create and develop musical ideas in relation to a brief. (Composing)

Assessment Objective 3 (AO3)

Analyse and evaluate music using musical terminology. (Appraising)